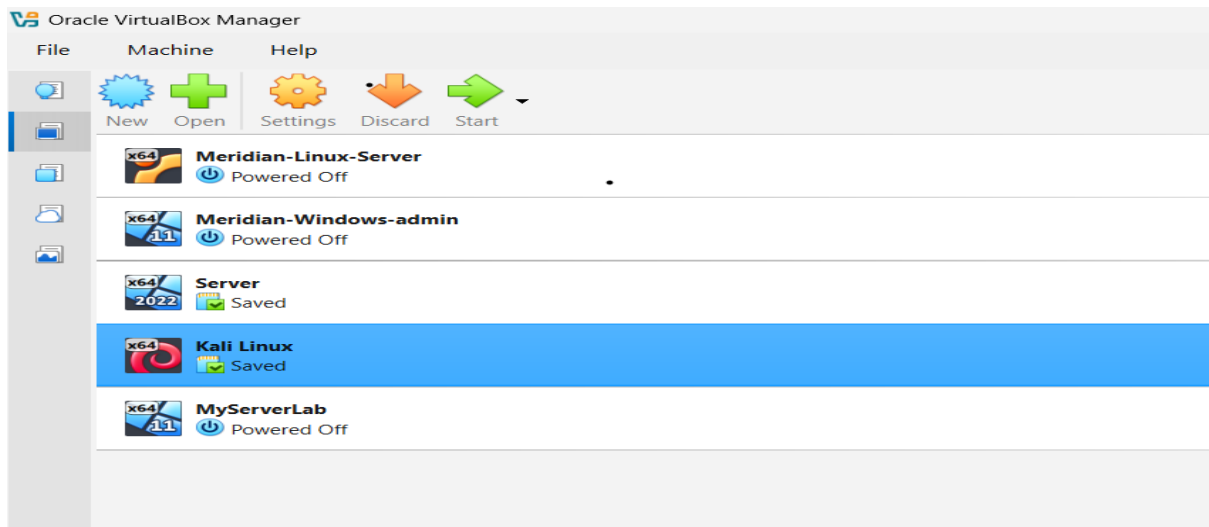
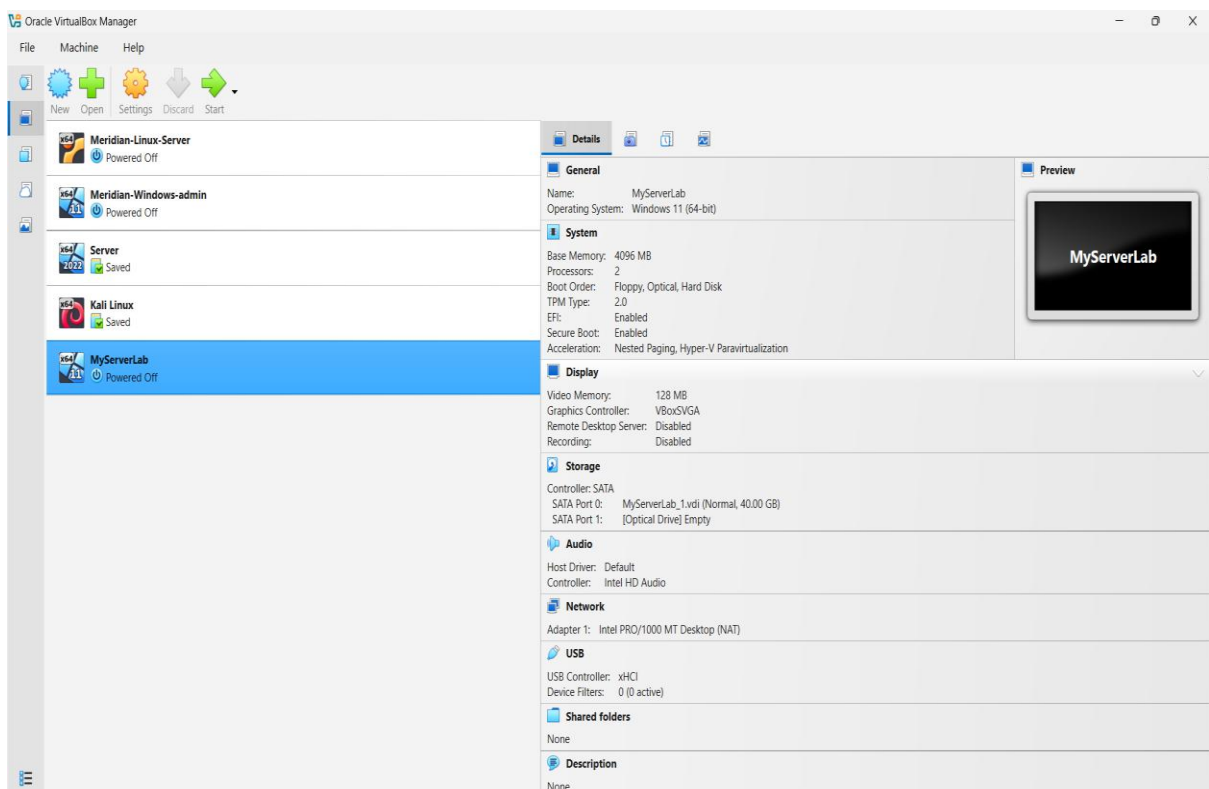


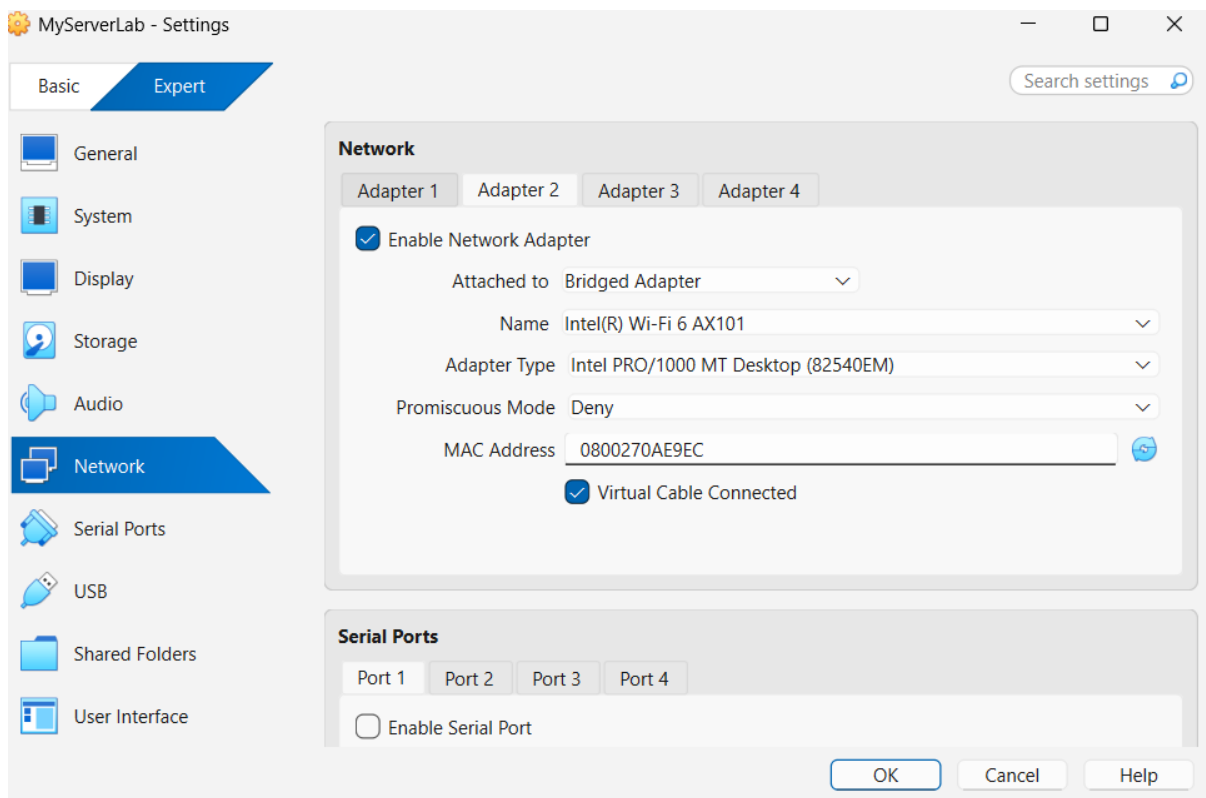
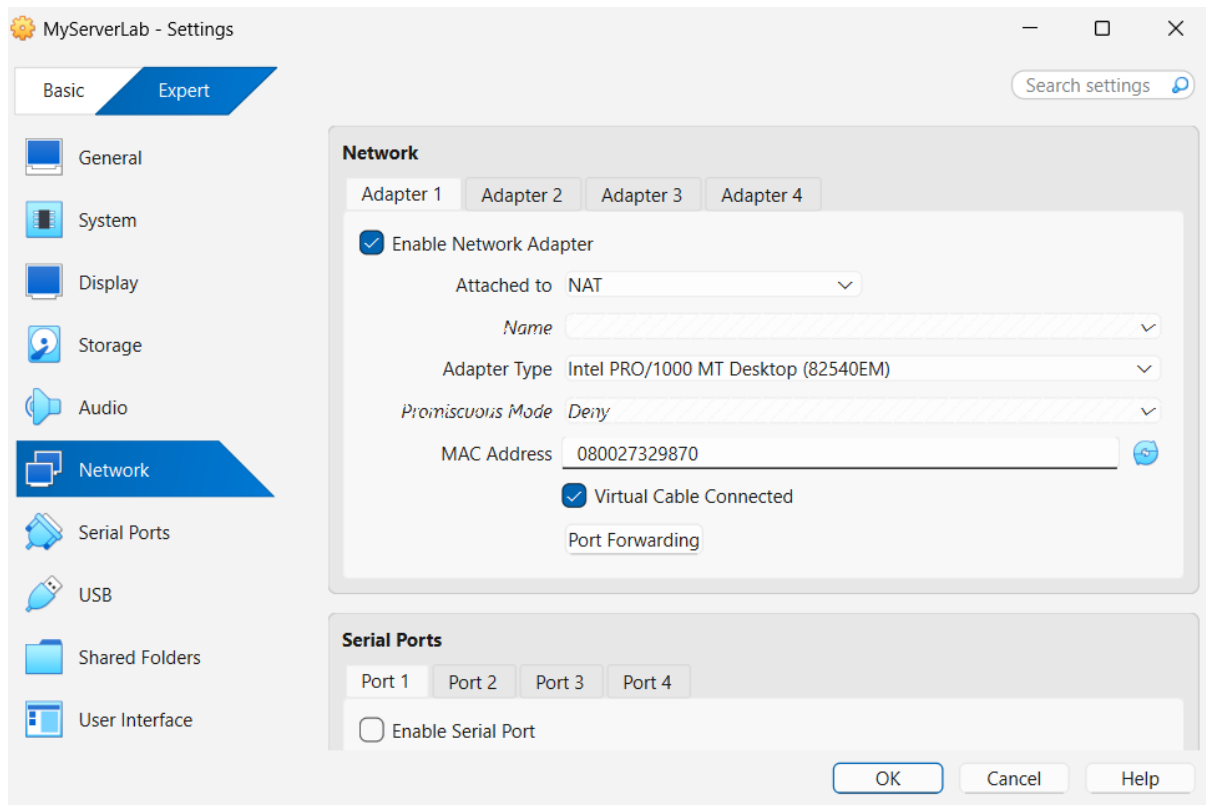
1. Install VirtualBox or VMware Workstation Player on your computer and create a new virtual machine named 'MyServerLab' with default settings.



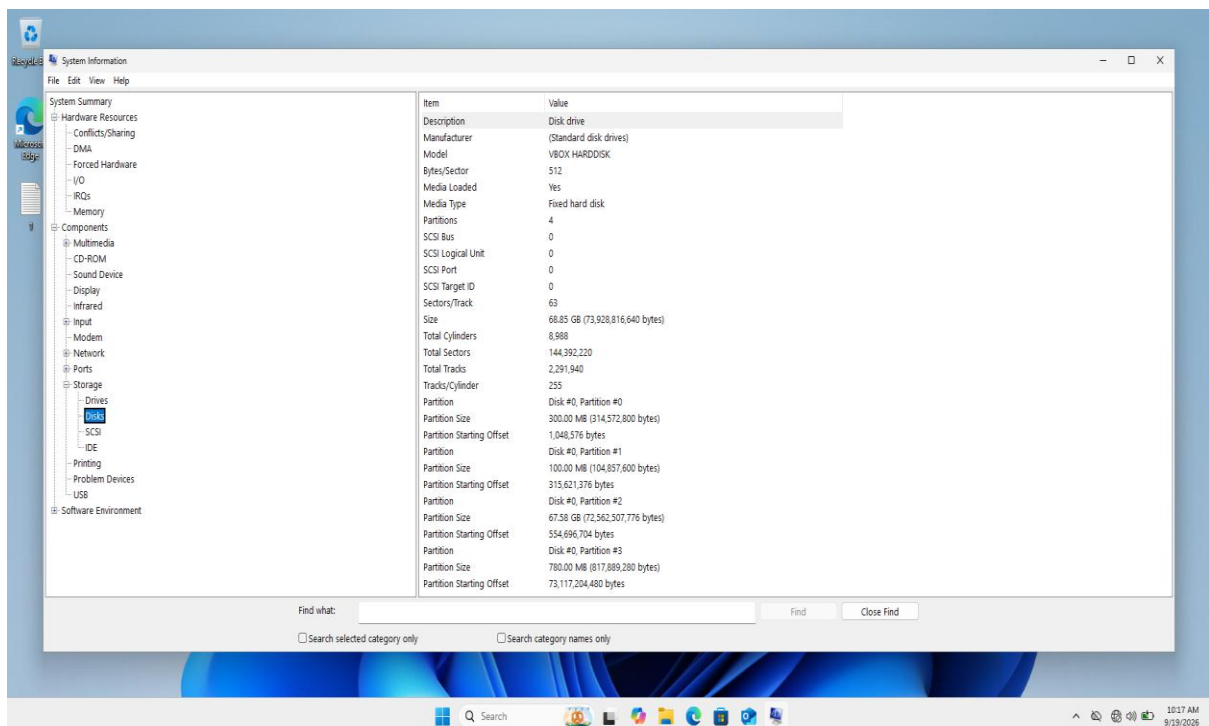
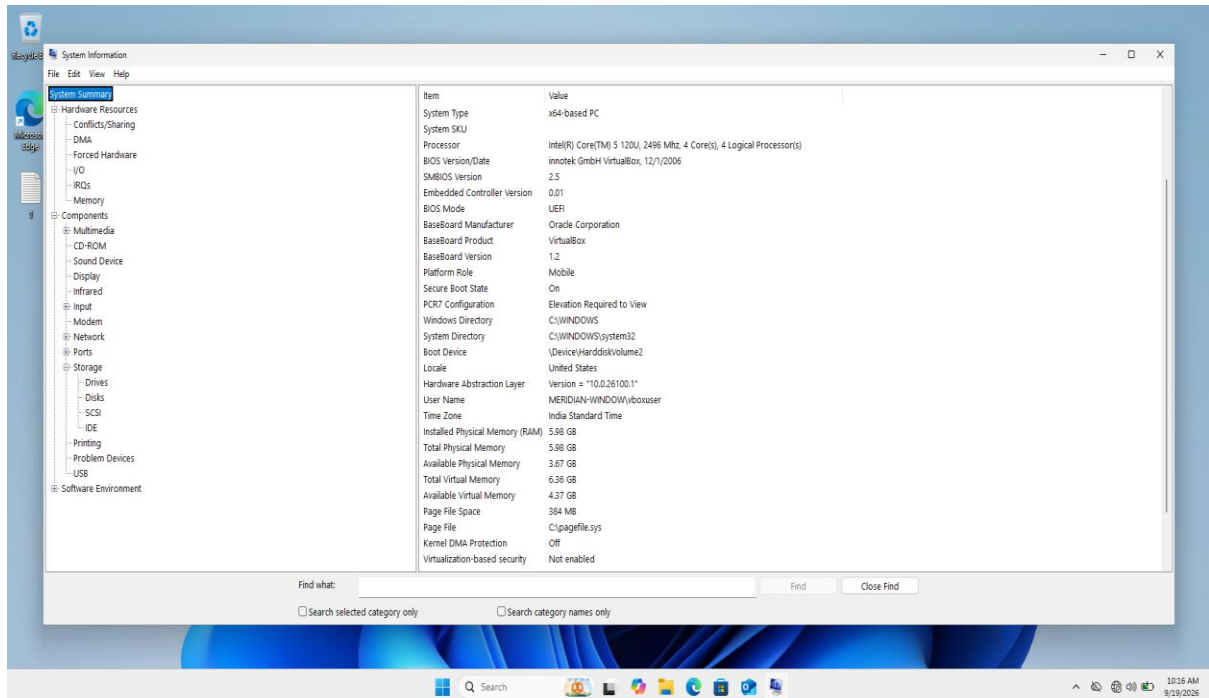
2. Within your 'MyServerLab' virtual machine, configure the hardware settings to assign 2 CPU cores, 4GB RAM, and a 40GB virtual hard disk.

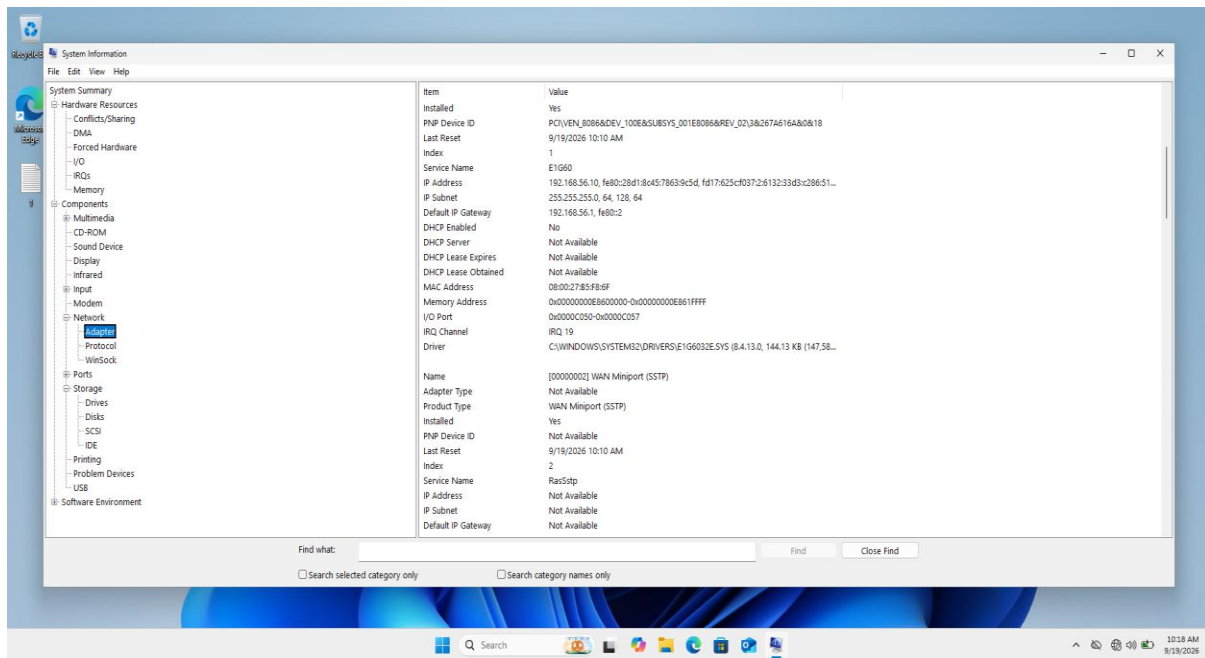


3. Add a second virtual network interface card (NIC) to your 'MyServerLab' VM and set one NIC to NAT and the other to Bridged mode.

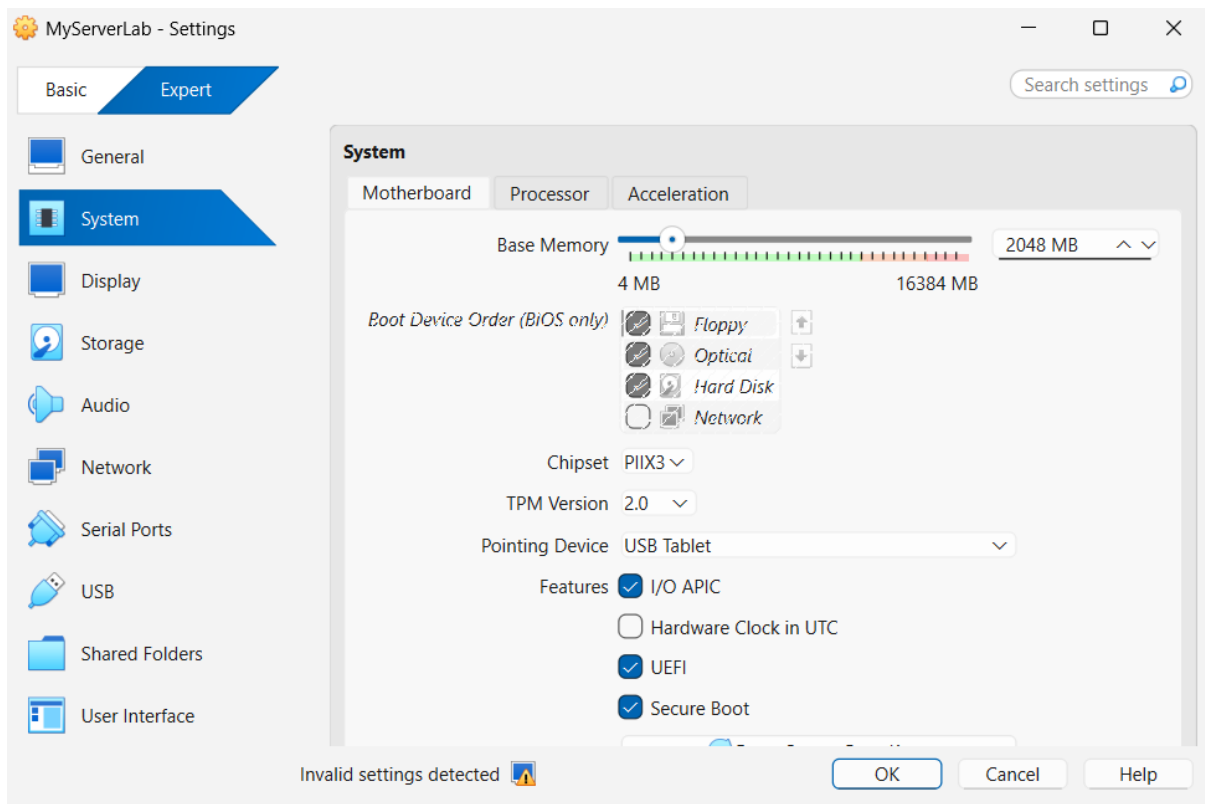


4. Boot your virtual machine and use the system information tool (like 'System Information' on Windows or 'lshw' on Linux) to list the detected CPU, RAM, storage, and network interfaces. Take a screenshot of the output.





5. Change the RAM allocation for your virtual machine from 4GB to 2GB, restart the VM, and observe any performance changes or warning messages. Write a short note on how RAM size impacts server performance.



RAM size impacts server performance because RAM provides temporary working memory for the operating system and applications. When a server has more RAM, it can handle more applications, services and users altogether. Reducing the VM's RAM from 4 GB to 2 GB can make the system slower especially when multiple applications are running. With sufficient RAM the operating system may use virtual memory on the storage device which is slower than physical RAM. Therefore, allocating sufficient RAM helps to maintain better server performance and responsiveness.